

THE INTENTIONAL INTERNET

A market map for a user-governed digital diet,
AI editor, and finite daily edition

TODAY'S EDITION

28

companies and
product families

THE QUESTION

Who decides what
deserves access to your
attention?

Research current to 23 Aug 2026

The category is real. The exact product is still unclaimed.

The market has validated every ingredient separately — but no durable consumer product yet combines them into one explicit attention-allocation system.

01

Validated demand

Mailbrew proves people want useful content without entering feeds. Tapestry proves people will crowdfund algorithm-free aggregation. Are.na proves an aligned, member-funded information environment can sustain meaningful revenue.

02

Competitive compression

Specialist readers own ingestion, filters and reading. AI assistants now own proactive briefs, user context and natural-language goals. The opportunity is narrower — and more specific — than “AI news.”

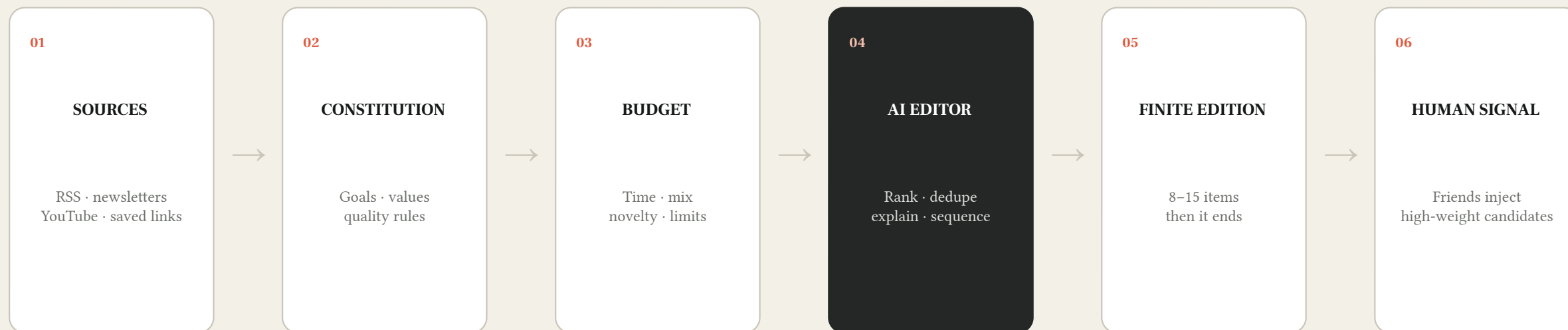
03

The remaining wedge

A source-transparent AI editor constrained by a user-written editorial constitution, a hard time/content budget, a finite stop state, and trusted-human recommendations.

BOTTOM LINE → Build an attention allocator, not another feed and not a generic daily brief.

The proposed product is a control system, not a reader.



Existing products cluster around one or two boxes.

The concept's differentiation comes from making the constitution and budget first-class — then turning the result into a bounded object rather than another stream.

Four signals say “intentional information” is a real paid niche.

60K+

Mailbrew users

7.5M+ digests delivered

\$177.8K

Tapestry Kickstarter

3,369 backers

20,516

Are.na paying members

\$125,085 monthly recurring revenue

42%

sometimes/often avoid news

up from 29% in 2017

Interpretation

This is stronger evidence for a \$5–12/month power-user market than for a mass-market social platform. The demand is “help me remain informed without feeling captured.”

SOURCE [Mailbrew](#) · [Kickstarter](#) · [Are.na](#) · [Reuters Institute DNR 2026](#)

The market is six overlapping categories, not one.

DIGEST-FIRST

Mailbrew · NewsBlur
Meco · newsletter digests

Scheduled condensation

FEED CONTROL

Tapestry · Reeder · Feeeed
Inoreader · Folo

Own the inputs and order

READING OS

Readwise Reader · Matter
Instapaper · KTool

Capture, consume, retain

AI NEWS

Particle · Ground News
Apple News · Flipboard

Summarize and personalize

AI ASSISTANTS

Gemini · Claude · ChatGPT
Dia · Perplexity

Know goals and act proactively

HUMAN DISCOVERY

Are.na · Sublime · Cosmos

Taste, people, serendipity

The proposed product sits at the intersection of all six — which creates both differentiation and scope risk.

The strongest threat is no longer another RSS startup.

Threat = ability to satisfy the same job with existing distribution, context, or habit.

CATEGORY

REPRESENTATIVE PRODUCTS

NOW

2Y

WHY IT MATTERS

AI assistants	Gemini Daily Brief · Claude scheduled tasks · ChatGPT daily briefs · Dia Morning Brief			Own context + habit + proactive delivery
Reading OS	Readwise Reader · Matter · Instapaper			Own capture and deep-reading workflow
Digest tools	Mailbrew · NewsBlur · Meco			Own finite cadence and source aggregation
Feed control	Inoreader · Tapestry · Reeder · Folo · Fееeed			Own source choice, rules and chronology
AI news	Particle · Ground News · Apple News			Own packaged news and publisher relationships
Human discovery	Are.na · Sublime · Cosmos			Own taste networks and social serendipity

Strategic implication: source governance + bounded consumption must be the product, because “personalized morning brief” is becoming a platform feature.

Direct and near-direct competitors: digest + feed control.

PRODUCT	PRIMARY JOB	INPUTS	WHAT IT OWNS	PRICE SIGNAL
Mailbrew	Daily email digest	RSS, newsletters, YouTube, web sources	Finite cadence; strong demand proof	\$59/yr
NewsBlur	Trainable RSS + daily briefing	RSS, web feeds, newsletters	User training; briefing; clustering	\$36–99/yr
Inoreader	Power-user monitoring	RSS, web, newsletters, social	Rules, filters, digests, AI reports	\$90/yr
Feedly	AI monitoring / intelligence	Web and publisher ecosystem	Strong AI feeds; B2B depth	\$1,600+/mo B2B
Folo	AI RSS reader	RSS + broad content connectors	Open source; AI summaries/digest	Freemium
Tapestry	Universal chronological timeline	RSS, Bluesky, Mastodon, YouTube	No algorithm; private; extensible	\$20/yr
Reeder	Unified reading timeline	RSS, video, podcast, social	No unread pressure; local/privacy	\$10/yr
Feeeed	Build-your-own anti-doom feed	RSS, YouTube, Reddit, email	Private; reminders + life cards	Free

Closest current bundles Mailbrew ≈ finite digest | NewsBlur ≈ trainable ranking + briefing | Inoreader ≈ rules + automation | Folo ≈ AI reader

Direct and near-direct competitors: reading, news and daily briefs.

PRODUCT	PRIMARY JOB	INPUTS	WHAT IT OWNS	PRICE SIGNAL
Readwise Reader	Reading operating system	Feeds, email, saved items, files	Capture, full text, highlights, AI	\$120/yr
Matter	Read later + subscriptions	Saved links, newsletters, RSS	Polished reading + AI co-reader	\$60–80/yr
Instapaper	Read later + Kindle digest	User-saved articles	Daily/weekly Kindle delivery	\$60/yr
KTool	Send content to Kindle	Articles, newsletters, documents	Digest/magazine conversion	\$48/yr
Meco	Newsletter reading hub	Gmail, Outlook, Meco inbox	AI summaries + daily audio roundup	\$40/yr
Particle	AI-personalized news	Multi-publisher news + podcasts	Story synthesis + perspectives	\$30/yr
Gemini Daily Brief	Proactive personal briefing	Gmail, Calendar, Gemini chats	Context, actions, habit surface	Bundled paid plan
Claude scheduled tasks	Recurring research + briefings	Web + connected tools	Natural-language automation	Paid plans
Dia Morning Brief	Workday attention brief	Calendar, email, Slack, tabs	Browser context + proactive surface	\$100/mo tier

Most strategically important overlap: Instapaper already does scheduled Kindle digests; Gemini/Claude/Dia already do proactive, context-aware briefs.

Digest-first products validate the behavior — and expose the gap.

Mailbrew

Closest behavioral analogue. A scheduled email digest across multiple internet sources. Strong language around “unplugging from feeds,” clear demand proof, and a modest \$59/year ceiling.

Gap: configuration is mostly sources + cadence, not a persistent editorial constitution or explicit attention allocation.

NewsBlur

The most underrated technical competitor. Users train by author, tag, title and full text; Archive adds clustering, Ask AI and a Daily Briefing.

Gap: still an inbox/reader mental model. Training is preference-based, not goal/value-based; no hard edition budget.

Meco

Turns newsletters into a calmer reading space and now produces daily personalized audio roundups plus AI summaries.

Gap: newsletter-limited and optimized for skimming/listening, not cross-source editorial allocation.

Design lesson → A fixed delivery ritual is valuable; “why this item earned one of today’s slots” is still unowned.

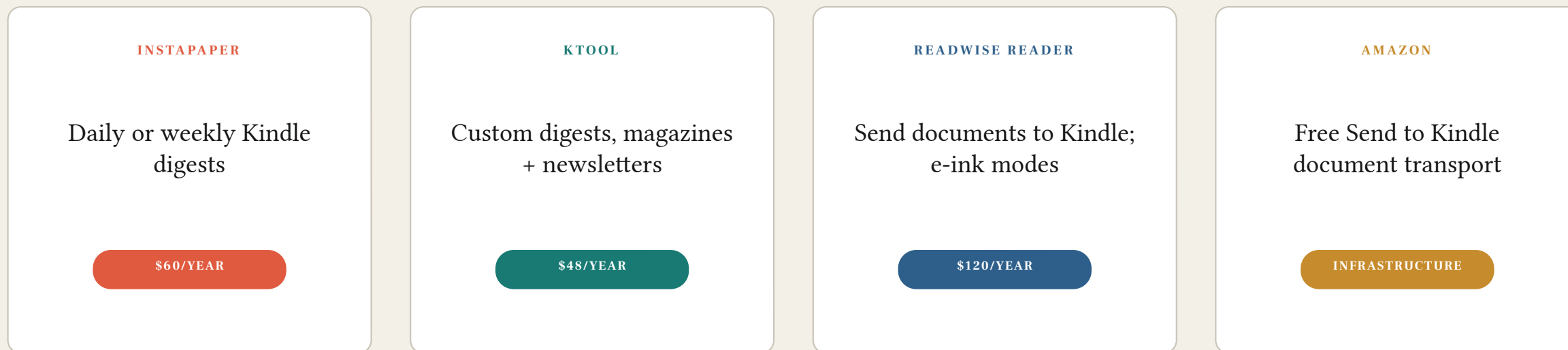
SOURCE [Mailbrew](#) · [NewsBlur](#) · [Meco](#)

Power readers are feature-rich — but make the user do editorial work.

INOREADER Rules, filters, monitoring feeds, newsletters, web feeds, AI summaries/reports, scheduled email digests. WHAT IT PROVES Excellent ingestion + automation backend. OPENING Complex; weak opinion about a healthy finished edition.	FEEDLY AI feeds for topics, companies and trends; deep enterprise monitoring and newsletter automation. WHAT IT PROVES Strong relevance models and B2B willingness to pay. OPENING Enterprise economics; not a personal wellbeing product.	FOLO Open-source AI RSS reader spanning multiple media types, summaries and digest workflows. WHAT IT PROVES Modern UX + fast community adoption. OPENING Still centered on a reader/feed; governance is mostly implicit.
---	--	---

Their feature breadth is a warning: do not compete by rebuilding every connector and rule engine first.

The Kindle wedge is validated — and already monetized.



The differentiator cannot be “articles on Kindle.”

- Selection before conversion — the edition is composed, not merely bundled.
- A hard daily content/time budget — scarcity is a feature.
- Traceable reasons and balance — every slot has an editorial rationale.
- Feedback improves the constitution, not an opaque engagement score.

SOURCE [Instapaper premium](#) · [KTool pricing](#) · [Readwise Reader](#)

Algorithm-free products prove control matters — but preserve the scroll.

TAPESTRY

One private chronological timeline across RSS, Bluesky, Mastodon, Tumblr, YouTube and more.

Control mechanism: mute/muffle rules + source choice

FEEDER

A unified inbox for reading, watching and listening; removes unread counts and syncs timeline position.

Control mechanism: chronology + filters + calm interface

FEEDER

“A feed curated by you” spanning RSS, YouTube, Reddit, email, reminders and personal cards.

Control mechanism: user-built feed + private-by-design

Opportunity: preserve user sovereignty, then replace “keep scrolling” with “today is complete.”

AI news products solve synthesis, not the user's wider information diet.

Particle

Multi-source stories, opposite-side views, custom summary styles, questions, podcasts and daily digests. \$15.3M raised; iOS + Android; 1.2K US App Store ratings at 4.8.

Strategic read: best current AI-news execution — but the unit is a news story, not a life goal or attention budget.

Ground News

Clusters reporting across 50,000+ outlets and exposes political bias, factuality, ownership and blindspots.

Strategic read: users will pay for epistemic tools and source comparison; its differentiator is perspective, not finite curation.

Apple News / Flipboard

Large-scale personalized aggregation, editorial packaging, publisher access and established distribution.

Strategic read: never compete on generic “personalized news.” Win on user governance, cross-domain scope and an intentionally bounded object.

SOURCE [Particle](#) · [Ground News](#) · [Apple News](#)

General AI assistants have crossed into the core job-to-be-done.

In 2026, daily briefing is becoming a platform primitive.

GEMINI	Daily Brief curates Gmail, Calendar and chat context every morning; adapts to feedback and suggests actions.	VERY HIGH	
CLAUDE	Scheduled tasks explicitly support daily briefings and recurring topic/competitor research across connected tools.	HIGH	
CHATGPT	Official workflows support source-backed daily work briefs and recurring automation around user context.	HIGH	
DIA	Morning Brief draws from calendar, email, Slack and tabs; it appears in the browser’s default surface.	MED-HIGH	

Survival rule: do what platform briefs structurally will not — let the user inspect and govern the editorial policy, cap the edition, preserve full-source reading, and route to e-ink/offline.

Human curation is not a side feature — it is the trust and serendipity layer.

ARE.NA

Member-supported knowledge network with no advertising. 20,516 paying members and \$125K MRR.

Proof: aligned incentives can be the business model.

SUBLIME

Human-curated ideas and related material; \$75/year premium with Kindle, X, Instagram and Readwise integrations.

Proof: users pay for slower, idea-centric discovery.

COSMOS

Visual inspiration network built around tastemakers, friends and collaborative collections; can hide AI content.

Proof: taste graphs can outperform topic graphs for discovery.

Product mechanic to test: “send to Charl’s paper” adds a high-weight candidate — not a notification, public post, like count or obligation.

No competitor currently combines all seven control primitives.

CONTROL PRIMITIVE	Mailbrew	NewsBlur	Inoreader	Readwise	Instapaper	Particle	Gemini	Proposed
Own sources	●	●	●	●	○	○	—	●
Natural-language goals	—	—	—	○	—	○	●	●
Editorial constitution	—	○	○	—	—	—	○	●
Hard attention budget	○	—	—	—	—	—	—	●
Finite stop state	●	○	○	—	●	○	●	●
Full-source reading	○	●	●	●	●	○	—	●
Trusted friend signal	—	○	○	—	—	○	—	●

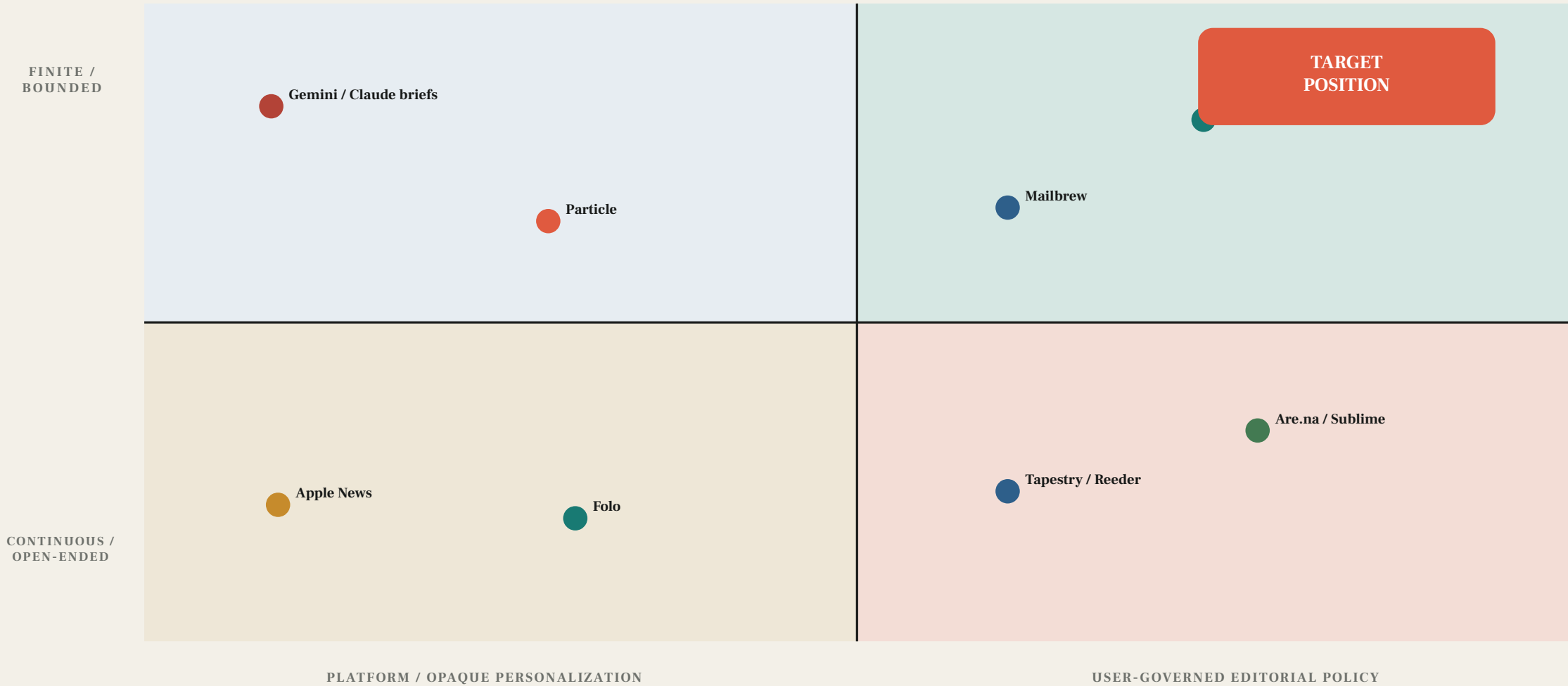
● Strong/native

○ Partial/adjacent

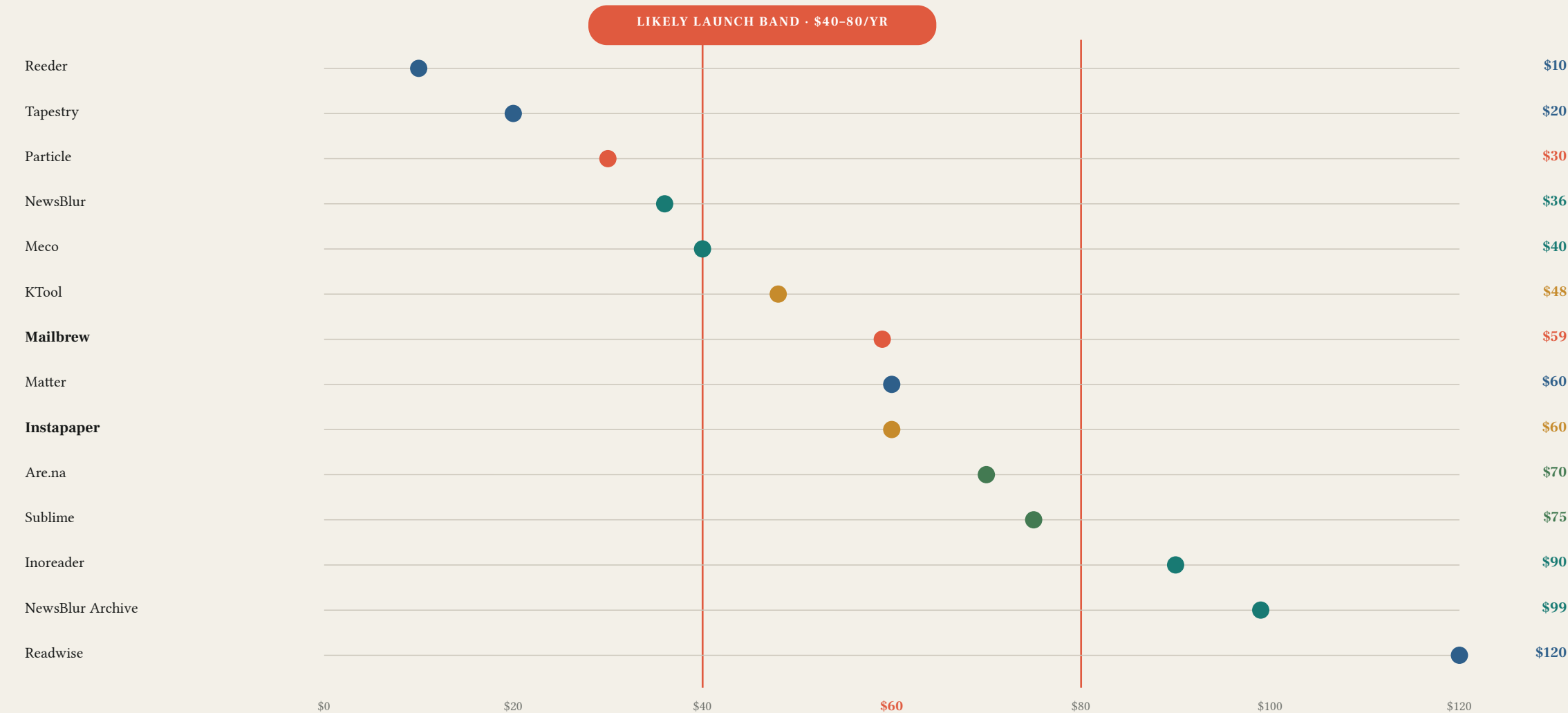
Whitespace = policy + budget + stop state

POSITIONING MAP

The whitespace is “governed + finite,” not merely “personalized.”



Consumer willingness to pay clusters around \$40–120/year.



Price hypothesis → \$6-10/month, annual-first; charge for editorial value and calm, not connector count.

USD annualized; representative public prices, Aug 2026. App-store/local pricing varies.

Small cohorts can support meaningful businesses — but love is not mass-market proof.

Mailbrew

60K+ users

Behavior validated

Are.na

20.5K payers

\$125K MRR

Tapestry

3,369 backers

\$177.8K crowdfund

Particle

\$15.3M raised

1.2K ratings · 4.8

Omnivore

500K users

Acquired; standalone ended

Artifact

strong launch buzz

Standalone product ended

Base case: a durable, high-retention niche. Upside case requires proving behavior substitution — users actually stop opening feeds.

The graveyard is a strategic asset: three failure modes to avoid.

✗ ARTIFACT

Excellent AI-personalized news
was not enough.

The founders said the opportunity was not large enough
for continued investment; Yahoo acquired the technology,
not the standalone app.

Do not pitch “better AI news.”

✗ POCKET

Scale and brand did not
guarantee permanence.

Mozilla shut Pocket in July 2025 to focus elsewhere, despite
its iconic read-later position.

Make data portability and direct revenue
foundational.

✗ OMNIVORE

A beloved free reader can
become acquisition fuel.

The team joined ElevenLabs after reaching a reported 500K
global users; the open-source code survived, the standalone
service did not.

Free utility alone is not a business model.

SOURCE [Yahoo Artifact acquisition](#) · [Mozilla Pocket closure](#) · [ElevenLabs/Omnivore](#)

Universal ingestion is the moat trap.

RSS / SUBSTACK	Open / low friction	Best MVP substrate; Substack exposes /feed.
YOUTUBE	Quota-managed	Useful metadata access; transcripts/content add complexity.
X	\$0.005 per post read	10,000 new posts = \$50 before AI processing.
REDDIT	Approval + contract risk	Commercial use requires explicit written approval.
LINKEDIN	Restricted permission	Member social reads available only to approved users.
EMAIL NEWSLETTERS	Permissioned but messy	High-value content; parsing and account trust matter.

Recommended boundary → Start with RSS, newsletters, YouTube metadata and saved URLs. Add social sources only after the core selection behavior is proven.

A defensible wedge has five non-negotiables.

- | | | |
|----|---------------------------------|---|
| 01 | A constitution, not interests | Natural-language goals, values, quality preferences, exclusions and diversity requirements. |
| 02 | A hard attention budget | Minutes, item count, topic mix and novelty constraints determine the edition's size. |
| 03 | An explainable editorial ledger | Every selection states why it won, what it displaced and how it satisfies the policy. |
| 04 | A finite reading object | One daily edition that ends — ideally email + web + EPUB/Kindle from the start. |
| 05 | Trusted-human injection | Friends add weighted candidates without importing social graphs, virality or obligation. |

Positioning sentence: "Your values decide what earns a place in today's finite edition."

The MVP should test editorial delegation, not aggregation breadth.

1 10 users · 14 days

Manual onboarding interview + constitution; RSS/newsletters/saved URLs; 8–15-item daily web/email edition.

Prove replacement behavior.

2 30–50 paying users

Add EPUB/Kindle delivery, explanations, mix controls, “more/less like this” and one friend-send path.

Prove willingness to pay + retention.

3 Cohort expansion

Add YouTube, source-health diagnostics, edition analytics and referrals. Delay restricted social APIs.

Prove scalable acquisition.

Primary metric

Reduction in visits to the feeds the edition was intended to replace — not “articles opened.”

Four experiments can falsify the thesis quickly.

HYPOTHESIS	TEST	DESIGN	PASS SIGNAL
REPLACEMENT	Does the edition reduce feed visits?	Baseline device/self-report → 2-week delta	≥25% reduction among retained users
POLICY VALUE	Does a constitution beat source/topic setup?	Randomize onboarding: topics vs constitution	Higher day-14 use + fewer manual edits
FINITE VALUE	Does ending improve satisfaction?	Finite 10-item edition vs ranked endless list	Lower time, equal/higher “felt informed”
HUMAN SIGNAL	Do friend-sent candidates increase delight?	One trusted sender per user	Higher save/read rate without notification burden

Kill criterion: users like the output but do not change any underlying consumption habit.

The broader watchlist: 28 products and product families.

DIRECT / DIGEST	FEEDS / READERS	READING / PKM	AI / DISTRIBUTION	WELLBEING / SUBSTITUTES
Mailbrew	Inoreader	Readwise Reader	Gemini Daily Brief	one sec
NewsBlur	Feedly	Matter	Claude scheduled tasks	Opal
Meco	Folo	Sublime	ChatGPT daily briefs	Freedom
Instapaper	Tapestry	Are.na	Dia Morning Brief	ScreenZen
KTool	Reeder	Cosmos	Perplexity Discover	Unpluq
Particle	Feeeed	Raindrop.io	Apple News	Minimalist Phone

Monitor monthly for: launches · pricing · platform connectors · shutdowns/acquisitions · traction disclosures · daily-brief behavior · publisher deals

Selected sources: competitors and pricing.

- [Mailbrew — product, traction, pricing](#)
- [Tapestry — product](#)
- [Tapestry — Kickstarter results](#)
- [Reeder — App Store listing / price](#)
- [Feeeed — product](#)
- [Inoreader — features and pricing](#)
- [Feedly Market Intelligence — pricing](#)
- [NewsBlur — features and pricing](#)
- [Readwise Reader — product and pricing](#)
- [Matter — business model / pricing](#)
- [Instapaper — Premium and Kindle digests](#)
- [KTool — pricing and digest features](#)
- [Meco — product](#)
- [Meco PRO — pricing](#)
- [Particle — product, funding and Android launch](#)
- [Particle — App Store pricing and ratings](#)
- [Ground News — methodology](#)
- [Are.na — live member and revenue metrics](#)
- [Sublime — pricing](#)
- [Cosmos — product / pricing](#)

Hyperlinks are clickable in PowerPoint. Prices are public US web/App Store prices observed 23 Aug 2026; taxes, location and platform may change them.

Selected sources: market context, platforms and failure cases.

- [Reuters Institute Digital News Report 2026](#)
- [Gemini Daily Brief](#)
- [Gemini scheduled actions](#)
- [Claude Cowork scheduled tasks](#)
- [OpenAI Docs — ChatGPT/Codex use cases](#)
- [Dia Morning Brief release note](#)
- [Dia pricing](#)
- [Yahoo — Artifact acquisition](#)
- [Mozilla — Pocket closure](#)
- [ElevenLabs — Omnivore acquisition](#)
- [X API pricing](#)
- [Reddit Responsible Builder Policy](#)
- [LinkedIn Posts API permissions](#)
- [YouTube Data API quota](#)
- [Substack RSS documentation](#)
- [Apple News App Store listing](#)

Research emphasis: primary/official sources for features, prices, policies and company metrics; secondary reporting used sparingly for context.

How to read this deck.

01

Scope

Consumer and prosumer products that aggregate, filter, summarize, schedule, package or socially curate internet information; adjacent AI-assistant and wellbeing substitutes included where they compete for the same job.

02

Assessment

Features and public prices were checked against official sources where available. Threat, “ownership” and whitespace judgments are strategic inference — they are not claims made by the companies.

03

Limits

Private-company revenue, retention and user counts are usually undisclosed. “All competitors” therefore means a structured, decision-useful universe, not a claim of exhaustive global enumeration.

Recommended refresh cadence: quarterly for the specialist landscape; monthly for AI assistants and platform API access.